

Summary of Conclusions for  
Meeting of the NSC Principals Committee

DATE: September 25, 1995

LOCATION: White House Situation Room

TIME: 2:30 - 4:00 p.m.

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Principals Committee Meeting  
on Bosnia ~~(S)~~

## PARTICIPANTS:

THE PRESIDENT

THE VICE PRESIDENT

CHAIR

Anthony Lake

OVP

Richard Saunders

StateWarren Christopher  
(via SVTS from NY)

Strobe Talbott

Richard Holbrooke  
(via SVTS from NY)DODSecretary Perry  
Edward WarnerUSUNAmb. Madeleine Albright  
(via SVTS from NY)  
James O'BrienOMBAlice Rivlin  
Gordon AdamsChief of Staff

Leon Panetta

CIAGeorge Tenet  
Dennis BlairJCSCharles Krulak  
Michael ByronWhite HouseSandy Berger  
Nancy SoderbergNSCAlexander Vershbow  
John FeeleySummary of Conclusions

1. Principals, joined by the President and Vice President for part of the meeting, were briefed by the U.S. delegation on the U.S. diplomatic initiative and discussed next steps in the peace process and preparations for implementation of a possible peace settlement in Bosnia. (U)

2. New York Foreign Ministers Meeting: Secretary Christopher and Ambassador Holbrooke briefed Principals on the preparations for the next day's meeting in New York of the Foreign Ministers of Bosnia, Croatia and the Federal Republic of Yugoslavia. They agreed that, following agreement by the three on "further agreed principles" for a settlement, building on the September 8 Geneva principles, the next priority would be to negotiate a country-wide cessation of hostilities. ~~(S)~~

3. International Conference: Principals agreed that, following the New York Foreign Ministers' meeting and attainment of a cessation of hostilities, we would need to move beyond shuttle diplomacy to the convening of an international conference in "proximity talks" format. They agreed that Ambassador Holbrooke should seek the parties' agreement to a date for such a conference in mid-to-late October, subject to their acceptance of the following conditions: a) each of the three parties will send representatives with the authority to make decisions; b) the parties will not threaten to walk out of the talks once they have convened; and c) the parties will agree not to talk to the press for the duration of the talks. Principals agreed that the international conference should be held in a location isolated from the media (i.e. not Geneva or New York), but they deferred a decision on a specific venue. They agreed in principle that the international conference would be co-chaired by the U.S. and EU, unless this posed serious difficulties for our relations with the Russians. ~~(S)~~

4. Military Implementation Planning: The Acting Chairman of the JCS briefed Principals on the status of NATO planning for implementation of a peace agreement. Principals agreed that, in response to the anticipated request from SACEUR for an estimated U.S. force contribution, we should continue to indicate a readiness to provide 20-25,000 ground troops. ~~(S)~~

5. Civilian Implementation Structure: Principals approved the civilian implementation structure proposed by State, but deferred a decision on whether to seek the appointment of an American national as Senior Coordinator. They agreed that we should seek to reduce the UN's role to the extent possible, with the authority for the civilian coordinator flowing from the peace agreement itself rather than a UNSC resolution. ~~(S)~~

6. Allied and Congressional Consultations: Principals reviewed plans for upcoming consultations with key Allies, noting the importance of engaging the Italians as well as our Contact Group partners in discussions of implementation planning. The President stressed the importance of early consultations with the Congress on NATO planning in order to defuse potential opposition to U.S. participation in the NATO Implementation Force. ~~(S)~~

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